Tier pack: Supported route — Make the identity piece: pattern and portrait

Pathway: TRACK · Week 4 Part 1 · Big question: How can we combine a bold repeating background pattern with a high-contrast central identity subject?

Supported route studio steps

Step 1: Use your Week 3 plan or a centre guide frame to sketch your main identity symbol large on heavy card.

Step 2: Draw a repeating pattern of lines and dots around the background using bright oil pastels.

Step 3: Brush a contrasting watercolour or ink wash over the background pattern.

Step 4: Fill your central symbol with bold dry tone and trace its outer edge with a thick black marker.

Success check

Large central motif with oil-pastel resist patterned background and bold contour.

Key words helper

• figure-ground: The visual separation between the main subject (figure) and the background space (ground).

• rhythm: A visual beat created by repeating shapes, lines, or colours across a pattern.

• halo: A thin band of contrasting tone around the main subject that makes it pop forward.

Review checklist

[ ] Step back two paces from your easel or desk to check that the central subject pops out from the patterned background.

[ ] Check that any wet wash areas are flat and drying cleanly.

[ ] Place your artwork on the drying rack with your Week 3 plan clipped alongside.